MILITARY SPECIFICATION

VARNISHES, ELECTRICALLY INSULATIVE, MOISTURE-, FUNGUS-, AND HIGH-TEMPERATURE-RESISTANT

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specification covers three types of moisture-, fungus-, and high-temperature resistant electrically insulative varnishes suitable for use on assembled communications, electronic, and associated electrical equipment.

1.2 Classification. Electrically insulative varnishes covered by this specification shall be of the following types and classes, as specified (see 6.2).

Type I. Polyimide resin.

Type II. Phenylene oxide resin.

Type III. Amide-imide resin.

Class A. General use. (Use in areas where Air Pollution Regulations do not exist.)

Class B. Limited use.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of the specification to the extent specified herein.

SPECIFICATIONS

Federal

TT-P-143	Paint, Varnish, Lacquer, and Related Materials, Packaging, Packing, and Marking of
TT-T-306	Thinner; Synthetic-Enamel

Military

MIL-P-997	Plastic Material, Laminated, Thermosetting, Electric Insulation, Sheets, Glass Cloth, Silicone Resin

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Federal

Federal Test Method Standard No. 141	Paint, Varnish, Lacquer, and Related Materials; Methods of Inspection, Sampling and Testing

Military

MIL-STD-105	Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes
MIL-STD-129	Marking for Shipment and Storage

(Copies of specifications, standards, drawings, and publications required by suppliers in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Preproduction sample. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2), a preproduction sample of varnish shall meet the requirements of this specification.

3.2 Materials. The base resin materials shall be chemically identified as classified in 1.2. The volatile portion of the varnish shall be any suitable solvent of such nature that it will not constitute a hazard to using personnel.

3.2.1 Types I, II and III - Class A. The materials, Classes A and B, shall be suitable for application by spraying, dipping or brushing techniques.

3.2.2 Types I, II and III - Class B. Class B material shall contain only nonphotochemically reactive solvents or thinners. Nonair polluting Class B material may be used in areas not having air pollution regulations.

3.2.2.1 Nonphotochemically reactive solvent. The nonphotochemically reactive solvent ingredient of class B material shall not exceed any one of the following percentage composition limitations with reference to the

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total volume of the solvent:

(a) A combination of hydrocarbons, alcohols, aldehydes, esters, ethers or ketones having an olefinic or cycloolefinic type unsaturation: 5 percent.

(b) A combination of aromatic compounds with eight or more carbon atoms to the molecules except ethylbenzene: 8 percent.

(c) A combination of ethylbenzene, ketones having branched hydrocarbon structures, trichloroethylene or toluene: 20 percent.

3.2.3 Thinner. The thinner used with the class B coatings shall be nonphotochemically reactive as defined in 6.4, and shall be compatible with the coatings.

3.3 Chemical and physical properties. Chemical and physical properties of the liquid varnish shall be as specified in table I.

Table I. Chemical and physical properties.

Property and condition.	Values		
	Type I	Type II	Type III
Solids content:percent by wt.,min.	13	50	32
Volatile content:percent by wt., min.	87	50	68
Cure time: at 350°F, hours max.	1	1	1
Viscosity, Brookfield, poises, max. @ 25°C	10		75
Viscosity, Demmler No. 1, sec., max. @ 25°C		65	

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3.4 Low temperature stability. The varnishes shall remain clear after storage for 24 hours at 0° centigrade (C) (32° Fahrenheit (F)) and testing as specified in 4.7.1.

3.5 Storage stability. When tested as specified in 4.7.2, the varnishes shall exhibit no sedimentation or separation which cannot be easily redispersed by hand stirring and which will not remain dispersed after standing for 30 minutes. The varnishes shall not corrode their containers and shall show no increase in viscosity sufficient to render them unsuitable for their intended purpose.

3.6 Application and film characteristics. The varnishes shall be suitable for application by spraying, dipping, or brushing. When thinned to suitable spray consistency, the varnishes shall spray in such a manner that the dried film will have a smooth, clear finish free from defects such as bubbles or cobwebbing. The dry film shall form a continuous, homogeneous, transparent coating.

3.6.1 Dielectric strength. The dielectric strength of the film shall be not less than 1500 volts per mil when tested as specified in 4.7.3.1 and 4.7.3.2.

3.6.2 Resistance to thermal shock and bending. The film shall show no evidence of cracking, splintering, or tackiness after exposure to temperatures ranging from -55° to +260°C (-67° to +500°F) as specified in 4.7.4.

3.6.3 Insulation resistance. The insulation resistance of varnished specimens shall be at least 10 times that of similar unvarnished specimens when tested as specified in 4.7.5.1 and 4.7.5.2.

3.6.4 Fungus resistance. The dried film shall resist the growth of fungi when tested as specified in 4.7.6.

3.7 Shelf life. The shelf life of the varnishes shall be not less than 1 year when stored in unopened containers at 4°C (40°F).

3.8 Workmanship. The varnishes shall be formulated and processed as required to produce high-quality material suitable for the purpose intended.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or order, the supplier may utilize his own or any

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other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.2 Preproduction sample. The preproduction sample shall be prepared using the same methods proposed for the preparation of subsequent production lots of coating material.

4.3 Classification of inspections. The inspection requirements specified herein are classified as follows:

a. Preproduction inspection (see 4.3.1).

b. Quality conformance inspection (see 4.3.2).

4.3.1 Preproduction inspection. Preproduction tests shall be performed only on the preproduction sample and shall consist of all the examinations and tests specified herein except as specified in the procurement documents (see 6.2).

4.3.2 Quality conformance inspection. Quality conformance inspections for acceptance of the coating material shall consist of, but not be limited to, the following examinations and tests:

a. Volatile content.

b. Cure time.

c. Low temperature stability.

d. Resistance to thermal shock and bending.

4.4 Sampling.

4.4.1 Sampling for test. Two filled containers shall be selected at random from each lot and the contents subjected to the tests specified in 4.3.2.

4.4.1.1 Lot. For purposes of sampling examinations and tests, a lot shall consist of all the material produced in one plant under essentially the same conditions, not exceeding 2500 pounds, and offered for delivery at one time.

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4.4.2 Sampling for inspection of filled containers. A sample of filled containers shall be taken at random in accordance with MIL-STD-105 at inspection level I and acceptable quality level (AQL) 2.5 percent defective to verify compliance with this specification in regard to fill, closure, all the requirements of section 5, and other requirements not involving tests.

4.4.3 Rejection. If any sample representing a lot is found to be not in conformance with this specification, it shall be cause for rejection and the lot represented by the sample shall not be considered acceptable.

4.5 Test conditions. Unless otherwise specified in a particular test method, all testing shall be conducted under standard laboratory conditions of 75° + 2°F and 50 + 5 percent relative humidity. All samples of varnish or varnish film shall be exposed to these conditions for not less than 3 hours prior to any inspection.

4.6 Preparation of test panels. Unless otherwise specified in a particular test method, all test panels shall be prepared from thoroughly cleaned, smooth sheet copper approximately 3-1/2 inches wide, 8 inches long, and 0.005 inch thick. The consistency of the varnish may be changed by the addition of thinner conforming to TT-T-306, but not by evaporation. Each panel shall be dipped into the varnish twice, one in the reverse direction so as to give a more uniform thickness of coating, and shall be withdrawn at a uniform rate by mechanical means. The consistency and the withdrawal rate of the panels shall be adjusted so that the final film thickness on one side of the panel shall be not less than 0.0015 and not more than 0.0020 inch. Thickness measurements shall be made on each panel by means of a dial-type micrometer graduated to 0.0001 inch. Care shall be taken, before dipping the panels, that the varnish has been in the dipping tank for a sufficient length of time to be free from air bubbles. Between dippings, panels shall be dried or partially dried for any suitable period (usually about 15 minutes but not to exceed 1 hour) which will result in a smooth, clear film upon multiple coating. The final coat shall be dried for 48 hours. The panels shall be dried in the same vertical position in which they were dipped, in an essentially dust-free chamber maintained as specified in 4.5.

4.7 Test methods. Low-temperature and storage stability shall comply with 4.7.1 and 4.7.2. Dielectric strength and insulation resistant tests prior to aging and after aging, fungus resistance and shelf life shall comply with and be conducted as described in 4.7.3 through 4.7.7 and in accordance with the following methods of Federal Test Method Standard No. 141.

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Test	Method
Solids content: percent by wt, min	4041 (for clear liquids)
Volatile content: percent by wt, max	4041 (for clear liquids)
Cure time	4061 (except temperature to be 350° ± 5°F)
Viscosity	4271
Application and film characteristics	4321, 4331, or 4341, as applicable.

4.7.1 Low-temperature stability. Varnish shall be poured into an 8-ounce covered jar and stored for 24 hours at 0°C (32°F). It shall then be brought to room temperature and kept there for at least 1 hour, after which it shall be stirred and examined for clarity and sedimentation (see 3.4).

4.7.2 Storage stability. A 1-gallon sample in an original unopened container shall be stored for 1 year at approximately 4°C (40°F). The varnish shall then be transferred to a glass container, stirred and after 30 minutes, examined for color, viscosity change, and signs of sediment and separation. The original container shall also be examined for signs of corrosion (see 3.5).

4.7.3 Dielectric strength tests. Two tests (one prior to aging and one after aging) shall be performed. The results of both tests shall be as specified in 3.6.1.

4.7.3.1 Dielectric strength prior to aging. The dielectric strength test prior to aging shall be conducted as follows:

a. Panels Four test panels of the size and material specified in 4.6 shall be thoroughly washed with soap and water, rubbed dry with clean cheesecloth, then cleaned with xylol-alcohol solvent (1:1) and rubbed dry with clean cheesecloth. The cleaned panels shall be thoroughly examined for dust or lint particles; contact of the surface to be coated with the hands or any other contaminating object, shall be avoided. A total of ten thickness measurements shall be made on the panels before coating, starting 1 inch from one end and making measurements 1-3/4 inches apart along lines 3/4 inch each side of the centerline of the panel. The average of these shall be

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taken as the average copper thickness. Thickness shall be measured with a dial-type micrometer calibrated to 0.0001 inch having a 2-inch-diameter anvil and a 1/4-inch diameter presser foot with a dead-weight load of 3 ounces. Two panels shall then be placed together and sealed at the edges with masking tape so that only one side of each panel will be coated when double-dipped, as specified in 4.6. After drying under conditions as specified in 4.6, the panels shall be separated without bending and cut into strips along the centerline.

b. Conditioning. Test strips shall be immersed in distilled water at a temperature of 23° ± 1.1°C (73.4° ± 2°F) for a period of 24 hours. Upon withdrawal from the water, the surface water shall be removed by blotting lightly with absorbent paper. The dielectric strength tests shall be made immediately and completed within 5 minutes after removal from the water.

c. Frequency. The frequency of the test potential shall be not greater than 100 cycles per second, and each part of the testing apparatus shall have a continuous rating of not less than 2 kilovolt-amperes. The waveform shall be a sine curve, and the voltage shall be measured by an approved method. The voltage may be controlled by an approved method which does not distort the wave more than 10 percent from a sinusoidal shape, and which does not subdivide the voltage in steps greater than 500 volts.

d. Procedure. Dielectric breakdown shall be measured at four points along the centerline of each strip at 1-3/4-inch intervals starting at a point about 1-1/2 inches from one end. Electrodes shall be cylindrical rods 1/4 inch in diameter with edges rounded to 1/32 inch radius, and the upper, movable electrode shall weigh 0.1 ± 0.005 pound. To prevent flashover, a "single shot" dielectric strength tester shall be used. The potential shall be applied at a low voltage and gradually raised at a rate so that puncture will occur in approximately 10 to 15 seconds. Five thickness measurements shall be made on each strip at the same points at which the original copper-panel thicknesses were measured. The average volts per mil shall be determined by the following procedure: The average thickness of the panel before coating shall be substracted from that of the panel (two strips) after coating, to give the net-average film thickness.

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The eight breakdown voltages obtained on each panels (two strips) shall be averaged and divided by the average film thickness for the panel. The four resulting dielectric strengths shall then be averaged and this value reported as the dielectric strength (volts per mil) of the varnish.

4.7.3.2 Dielectric strength after aging test. Panels shall be prepared and the test conducted in the same manner as 4.7.3.1 except that the test strips prepared in accordance with 4.7.3.1a shall be air aged for 100 hours at 260° ± 3°C (500 ± 5°F) prior to continuing with 4.7.3.1b.

4.7.4 Resistance to thermal shock and bending. Two coated panels prepared as specified in 4.7.3.1a shall be subjected to four temperature cycles, each consisting of 3 hours at 85°C (185°F) followed by 3 hours at -55°C (-67°F). Transfer from one temperature to the other shall be effected at once. The panels shall then be conditioned from 1 to 24 hours at 23°C (73.4°F). The two panels shall each be cut into two strips, 1 by 8 inches (the edges of the dielectric strength test panels shall not be used for these strips), and given a flexibility test by bending the strips with the film outside, around a 1/2-inch mandrel through an angle of 180°. The film shall be examined for evidence of cracking, splintering, or tackiness (see 3.6.2).

4.7.5 Insulation resistance tests. Two tests (one prior to aging and one after aging) shall be performed. The results of both tests shall be as specified in 3.6.3.

4.7.5.1 Insulation resistance prior to aging test. The insulation resistance test prior to aging shall be conducted as follows:

a. Apparatus. The apparatus shall consist of the following:

(1) An insulation-resistance tester possessing a useful range of at least 1 to 100,000 megohms, inclusive.

(2) A testing room cabinet, or container in which an atmosphere can be maintained at 23° ± 1.1°C (73.4° ± 2°F) and 96 ± 2 percent relative humidity. Care shall be taken to prevent rapid fluctuations of temperature within the specified range and consequent condensation.

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b. Specimens. The specimens shall be two-post thermal strips as shown on figure 1, made from 1/16-inch glass-silicone laminated sheet conforming to MIL-P-997. Panels 1.25 inches will be satisfactory.

c. Mounting. Ten thermal strips shall be used. Prior to mounting, the specimens shall be conditioned for at least 4 days at 23° ± 5°C (73.4° ± 9°F) and 50 ± 4 percent relative humidity. Five of the strips, constituting a set, shall be mounted as shown on figure 1. The other five thermal strips shall be mounted on another metal bar in the same manner.

d. Coating. One set of mounted strips shall be dipped once, with the strips horizontal, by the method specified in 4.6 except that the final thickness of the dry film on each side of the panel shall be not less than 0.0010 inch and not more than 0.0013 inch. There shall be no abnormal "buildup" of the film between the terminal posts on any of the thermal strips. The second set of mounted strips shall not be coated. The coated set shall be allowed to dry for 48 hours at 23° ± 5°C (73.4° ± 9°F) and 50 ± 4 percent relative humidity.

e. Procedure. Both the coated and uncoated set of specimens shall be exposed to the atmosphere specified in 4.7.5.1a(2) for 7 days prior to testing, and tested while still in the specified atmosphere. The ends of the copper wires shall be cleaned to the bare metal, and the electrodes of the insulation tester shall then be attached. After 1-minute electrification at 90 to 135 volts direct current, the resistance reading shall be taken. If the set of uncoated specimens has an average insulation resistance of more than 300 megohms and the coated specimens fail to meet ten times the uncoated value, tests shall be repeated.

4.7.5.2 Insulation resistance after aging test. Panels shall be prepared and the test conducted in the same manner as specified in 4.7.5.1 except that the test strips coated in accordance with 4.7.5.1d shall be air aged for 100 hours at 260° ± 3°C (500° ± 5°F) prior to continuing with 4.7.5.1e.

4.7.6 Fungus resistance. The fungus resistance of the dried film shall be determined as follows.

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4.7.6.1 Test organisms. The following fungi (see 6.3) shall be used:

	American Type Culture Collection No.	Quartermaster Culture Collection
Aspergillus niger	9642	QM386
Aspergillus flavus	9643	QM380
Penicillium funiculosum	9644	QM391
Trichoderma sp.	9645	QM365

4.7.6.2 Maintaining stock cultures. Cultures of these fungi shall be maintained separately on an appropriate medium such as potato-dextrose agar. The stock cultures may be kep for not more than 4 months in a refrigerator at approximately 3° to 10°C (37.4° to 50°F). Subcultures incubated at 28° to 30°C (82.4° to 86°F), for 7 to 20 days, shall be used in preparing the spore suspension.

4.7.6.3 Spore suspension. The spore suspension shall be prepared by pouring, into one subculture of each of the four fungi (see 4.7.6.1), a sterile 10-ml portion of a solution containing, per liter, 0.05 gram of a wetting agent such as dioctyl sodium sulfosuccinate (see 6.4), and shaking to dislodge the spores. Spore suspensions from the individual fungi shall then be poured together and mixed to provide a composite spore suspension for use in the test. The spore suspension may be prepared fresh each day or may be held in the refrigerator at 3° to 10°C (37.4° to 50°F), for not more then 7 days.

4.7.6.4 Procedure and evaluation of results.

a. Test medium. The test medium shall contain the following:

Distilled water	1,000 ml
Dextrose	40 grams
Peptone	10 grams
Agar	20 grams

The test medium shall be made up and autoclaved, approximately 100 ml to a flask, and then poured into petri dishes, about 25 ml per dish.

b. Specimens. A sheet of Whatman No. 2 filter paper, or equivalent, shall be dipped into the varnish and the film allowed to air dry for 48 hours. The test may be facilitated by providing, prior

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to dipping the filter paper into the varnish, a thin black pencil or ink line located 2 mm within the edge of each disk, to be cut later from the filter paper. (Observation as to the extent to which fungi grow upon the specimens may then be made by noting whether growth progresses beyond this line.) The viscosity of the varnish shall be adjusted if necessary, or the sheet shall be redipped to give an increase in dry weight of 80 to 120 percent to the filter paper. The dried sheet shall then be conditioned by immersing in slowly running tap water or in distilled water, using a separate container for each varnish under test, for 18 hours at room temperature, allowing to dry, and heating in a dry oven at 85°C (185°F) for 2 hours. Following the conditioning four circular specimens, each 3 cm in diameter, shall be cut or punched from the coated filter paper for each varnish under test.

c. Inoculation and incubation. Each specimen shall be deposited on the center of the surface of the set agar in a petri dish. The surface, including the surface of the specimen, shall then be inoculated with the composite spore suspension, either by spraying the suspension from a sterilized atomizer in such manner that the entire surface is moistened with the spore suspension, or by distributing 0.5 to 1.0 ml of the spore suspension from a sterilized pipette and tilting the dish to moisten the entire surface with the suspension. In each daily group of tests, four dishes of set agar without specimens shall be seeded with the spore suspension to serve as controls. The petri dishes shall be incubated at 28° to 30°C (82.4° to 86°F) and shall be examined after 7 days of incubation.

d. Evaluation of results. For the varnish to be considered fungus-resistant, the following are required:

(1) Fungus growth in control dishes. There shall be copious fungus growth in all four of the control dishes. (Absence of such growth requires repetition of the test and is not to be considered as indicating failure.)

(2) Contaminating growth in test dishes. Growth of bacteria, or of fungi obviously other than the test fungi, shall not occur within 1 cm of more than one specimen, nor occupy more than one-fourth of the area in more than one test dish.

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(Presence of such contaminating growth in more than one of the four dishes requires repetition of the test and is not to be considered an indication of failure. When such contaminating growth occurs in one dish only, that dish shall be discarded and the evaluation shall be based upon the remaining three dishes.)

(3) Fungus growth in test dishes. Growth of the test fungi, as observed with the naked eye (see 4.7.6.4b), shall not extend more than 2 mm over the edge and toward the center of any specimen. (Fungus growth may touch the specimen and grow to the designated distance over it periphery. If growth extends to a greater distance over one of the specimens, the test may be repeated. Upon such repetition, the varnish shall be considered fungus-resistant provided all specimens pass.)

4.7.7 Shelf life. After storage for not less than 1 year at approximately 4°C (40°F) in the manufacturer's unopened containers, the varnish shall meet all requirements of this specification when tested as specified herein.

4.8 Preservation, packaging, packing and marking shall be compliance with section 5.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Preservation, packaging, and packing. Materials shall be prepared for shipment in accordance with TT-P-143 for levels A, B or C as specified (6.2). Type and capacity of unit containers and whether drums shall be palletized shall be as specified (6.2).

5.2 Marking of shipments. In addition to any special markings required by contract or order, unit packages, intermediate packages and shipping containers shall be marked in compliance with TT-P-143 and MIL-STD-129.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. The varnish covered by this specification is intended for use, by spray, dip, or brush application, in the protection of communications, electronic, and associated electrical equipment against the effects of moisture, fungus, and elevated temperatures on the performance of the equipment. It is intended that this specification be used in conjunction with supplementary specifications specifying the method of application of the varnish and the treatment of the equipment to receive it.

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6.2 Ordering data. Procurement documents should specify the following:

a. Title, number, and date of this specification .

b. Type (see 1.2)

c. Whether a preproduction sample is required and, if so, pertinent details (see 3.1 and 4.3.1).

d. Level of packaging and level of packing required.

e. Type and capacity of unit containers required.

f. Whether drums should be palletized.

g. Special marking required.

6.3 Fungus resistance. The organisms used in the fungus-resistance test specified in 4.7.6 may be obtained from the American Type Culture Collection, 2112 M Street, N. W., Washington, D. C. 20007 or for service use, from Quartermaster Research and Engineering Center, Natick, Massachusetts 02172.

6.4 Nonphotochemically reactive solvent. A nonphotochemically reactive solvent is any solvent with an aggregate of less than 20 percent of its total volume of chemical compounds not exceeding the individual percentage composition limitations specified in 3.2.2.1.

6.5 Wetting agent. Dioctyl sodium sulfosuccinate, a wetting agent, is available under the trade name "Aerosol OT."

Custodians.

Air Force - 11

Reviewer activities:

Air Force - 84

Preparing activity:

Air Force - 11

Project No. 8010-F009

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SPECIFICATION ANALYSIS SHEET

Form Approved
Budget Bureau No. 22-R255

INSTRUCTIONS: This sheet is to be filled out by personnel, either Government or contractor, involved in the use of the specification in procurement of products for ultimate use by the Department of Defense. This sheet is provided for obtaining information on the use of this specification which will insure that suitable products can be procured with a minimum amount of delay and at the least cost. Comments and the return of this form will be appreciated. Fold on lines on reverse side, staple in corner, and send to preparing activity. Comments and suggestions submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document(s) or serve to amend contractual requirements.

SPECIFICATION

ORGANIZATION

CITY AND STATE

CONTRACT NUMBER

MATERIAL PROCURED UNDER A

☐ DIRECT GOVERNMENT CONTRACT ☐ SUBCONTRACT

1. HAS ANY PART OF THE SPECIFICATION CREATED PROBLEMS OR REQUIRED INTERPRETATION IN PROCUREMENT USE?

A. GIVE PARAGRAPH NUMBER AND WORDING.

B. RECOMMENDATIONS FOR CORRECTING THE DEFICIENCIES

2. COMMENTS ON ANY SPECIFICATION REQUIREMENT CONSIDERED TOO RIGID

3. IS THE SPECIFICATION RESTRICTIVE?

☐ YES ☐ NO *(If "yes", in what way?)*

4. REMARKS *(Attach any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this specification. If there are additional papers, attach to form and place both in an envelope addressed to preparing activity)*

SUBMITTED BY *(Printed or typed name and activity - Optional)*

DATE

DD FORM 1 JAN 66 1426

REPLACES EDITION OF 1 OCT 64 WHICH MAY BE USED.

AFLC-WPAFB-OCT 67 2M

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